User Guide

IWAC Conference Application for Heather Falconer

PenUltimate

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28 April 2026

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1 Introduction

The IWAC Conference Mobile Application was developed for the International Writing Across the Curriculum Association (IWAC). The application is designed to improve the conference experience by providing a centralized platform for attendee engagement. Many academic conferences rely on multiple tools for scheduling, sharing materials, and communication. This application aims to keep features simple and accessible in a single, easy to use platform. The IWAC App allows users to create personalized agendas, browse conference panels, access panel materials, and interact with other attendees through messaging and profiles. It is available for both iOS and Android devices and supports both in-person and virtual conference attendees.

This User Guide is intended for our end users who are the individuals attending the IWAC conference. The conference attendees will use the application to manage their schedule, view the conference panels, and interact with attendees. No technical background is required to navigate our application as we have purposefully designed it for easy use. For these users, Sections 2 and 3 will be most relevant as these detail the application overview and instructions on how to navigate each screen. The User Guide is also for the current IWAC App administrator who serves as the conference organizer. This user will be responsible for managing conference data and attendee access. This user will be given access to the Administrator's Manual which includes specific detail on data input to the database and other administrator knowledge of the application. They will have an understanding of the system's functionality and can refer to this guide for further understanding of navigation for a standard user. This guide is written with the assumption that all users have a basic familiarity with mobile devices and applications.

1.1 Applicability Statement

This User Guide applies to the version 1.0.0 release of the IWAC Conference Mobile Application, which was developed as part of a University of Maine Computer Science Capstone Project.

1.2 Purpose

The purpose of the IWAC Conference Mobile Application is to aid conference attendees by providing a centralized platform for managing schedules, accessing panel materials, and engaging with other participants. The purpose of this User Guide is to help users understand how to navigate through the application and effectively use all features. It provides step-by-step instructions, functionality descriptions, and guidance for common errors and troubleshooting.

1.3 How to Use This Document

Section 1: Introduction - Provides an overview of the application including its purpose, and the intended users of this guide.

Section 2: Overview - Describes the system's main features and capabilities to give users a general understanding.

Section 3: Instructions - Provides detailed step-by-step instructions for using each feature of the application. Each module describes its own functionality, procedures, expected results, and possible errors.

References: Includes all supporting materials such as error messages and recovery procedures.

It is recommended for first-time users to review Section 2 before using the application to get a general understanding of the system and the features it provides. When users are performing specific tasks within the application such as creating an account or messaging other users, they should refer to Section 3. Each subsection of Section 3 is organized by feature allowing users to efficiently locate the instructions to fit their needs. For any troubleshooting, users should refer to the "Probable Errors and Possible Causes" subsections within each module of Section 3 or the Error Messages part of the References section for help understanding specific error message pop-ups.

1.4 Related Documents

Num	*Title*	*Author*	*Date*	*Issue*
1	Software Requirements Specification (SRS)	PenUltimate	Fall 2025	1.0
2	Software Design Document (SDD)	PenUltimate	Fall 2025	1.0
3	User Interface Design Document (UIDD)	PenUltimate	Fall 2025	1.0

4	Administrator Manual (AM)	PenUltimate	Spring 2026	1.0

1.5 Conventions

Step-by-step instructions are presented as numbered lists. Additionally, system messages and user input shown in quotation marks.

1.6 Problem Reporting Instructions

1. First please review the error message that is displayed in the application.
2. Given the error messages, refer to the “Probable Errors and Possible Causes” subsections of Section 3 and the “Error Messages” part of the References section.
3. If the issue remains unresolved, please contact the IWAC conference administrator for further assistance.

2 Overview

The IWAC Conference Application is a mobile-based system designed to support attendees of the International Writing Across the Curriculum (IWAC) Conference. The system provides users with the ability to see conference schedules, view session details, manage personal itineraries, and interact with other participants through messaging and notifications.

The system accepts inputs from users such as account credentials, session selections, session filters, and messages. The application produces outputs including personalized schedules, filtered session lists, notifications, and access to presentation materials. Administrators provide inputs by creating and managing conference data, which is then shown to all users.

The system uses Supabase for storing conference information and integrations with external services for registration verification and content access, such as Resend and Google Drive.

The application assumes that users have a familiarity with mobile devices, including navigating screens, selecting options from lists, and interacting with standard interface elements such as buttons. No advanced technical knowledge is required to use the system. Administrators should be able to import a CSV file into the Supabase platform. The PenUltimate Administrator Manual describes the process of uploading conference data, if an administrator is not familiar with that process.

3 Instructions

This section provides detailed instructions for using the IWAC Conference Mobile Application. It is organized by the core features and it is designed to guide users on how they can navigate and efficiently interact with the system.

3.1 Authentication Module

This section discusses how to use the ‘Create Account’ and ‘Login’ screens along with their respective features. The Create Account screen will create a new user account for those who have already registered for the conference. Users will be able to reset their password from the Login screen using the “Forgot Password” button.

3.1.1 Create Account Screen

Functional Description

The create account screen is where new users who have registered for the conference go to create an account to use for the IWAC Application. When a user enters in their details and clicks the create account button the input is checked to ensure that the user entered in the correct information. It will then check to make sure that the email the person is using to create an account is within the registrants list. If everything is correct it will then create the new account, login the user, and navigate them to the personal agenda screen.

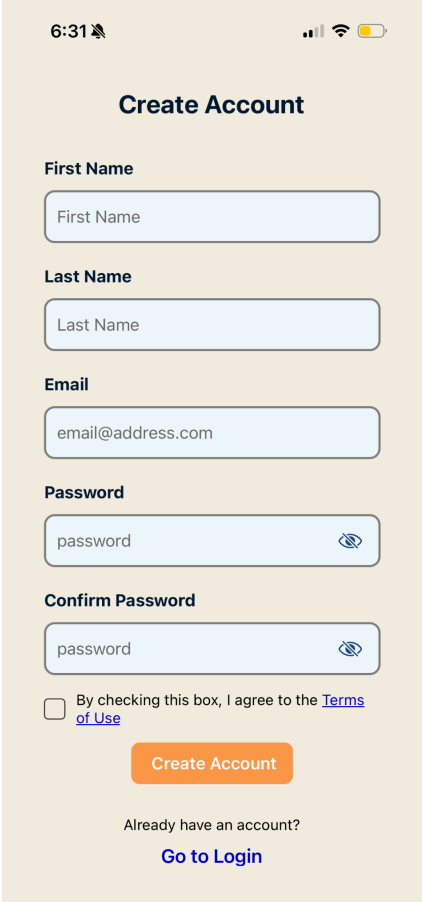

Figure 3.1.1 — Create Account Screen

Cautions and Warnings

- The email that is used to create an account must be the email used to sign up for the IWAC Conference. The application checks to make sure the email address is on the registrants list within the database.
- There are many different pop ups that contain error messages which could occur depending on whether the error is from the user input, database, etc. read the error message carefully and follow the instructions. Potential error messages include:
    - “Email and password required” Email, password, or confirm password input areas could be empty.
    - “First and last name required” First name or last name input areas could be empty.
    - “Password must be at least 6 characters” Ensure your password is at least 6 characters in length.
    - “Passwords do not match” Password and confirm passwords do not match please ensure that they are entered correctly.
    - “Error creating account, please try again” Error creating account with database ensure information is entered correctly and try again.

- “An IWAC App account already exists with this email.” The email entered is already on the registrants list, please contact the IWAC administrator.
- “Error checking registrants list” There was an error checking registrants list, please try again.
- “Your email is not allocated within the list of registrants please contact the IWAC administrator.” Your email is not allocated within the list of registrants please contact the IWAC administrator.

Procedures

Setup and Installation

1. Enter in appropriate credentials into text fields.
2. Click ‘Create Account’

Create Account

1. Enter in the following information: first name, last name, email, password, and confirm password.
2. Click the ‘Create Account’ button.
3. Click the verification link that is contained within the email sent to your email address. The email may be sent to your spam folder.

Expected Results

Will create an account with the corresponding information, then it will automatically login the user and navigate them to the personal agenda screen.

Probable Errors and Possible Causes

Error messages can pop up on the screen should it be necessary. The errors will either be about the user input, then you will just need to follow the instructions that the error message states and you can attempt to create an account again. Please see the cautions and warnings section of the create account screen to see all potential error messages.

The errors could also be about a problem with the call to the database in which case you should be able to attempt to login as long as the Supabase services are active.

3.1.2 Login Screen

Functional Description

The Login screen is where users who have already created an account can log in. Users will have to enter their email address and password and they will be logged into their account and redirected to the ‘Personal Agenda’ screen.

The Login screen also has ‘forgot password’ functionality. If a user wishes to change their password they can click the ‘Forgot Password’ button and the user will then be able to change their password given they follow the next steps.

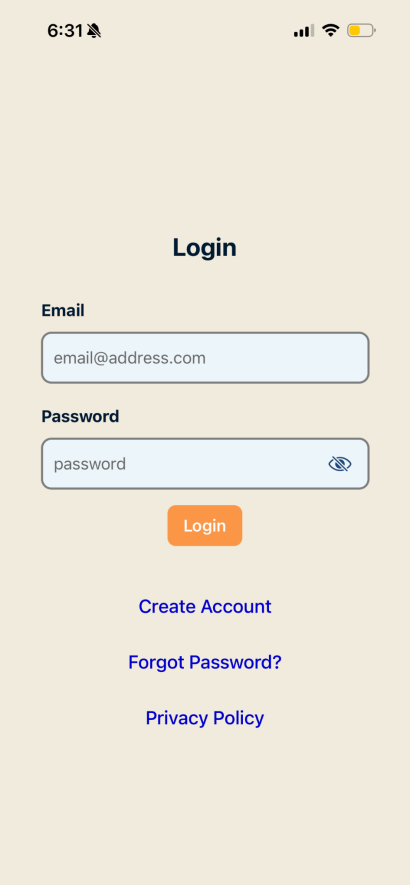

Figure 3.1.2 — Login Screen

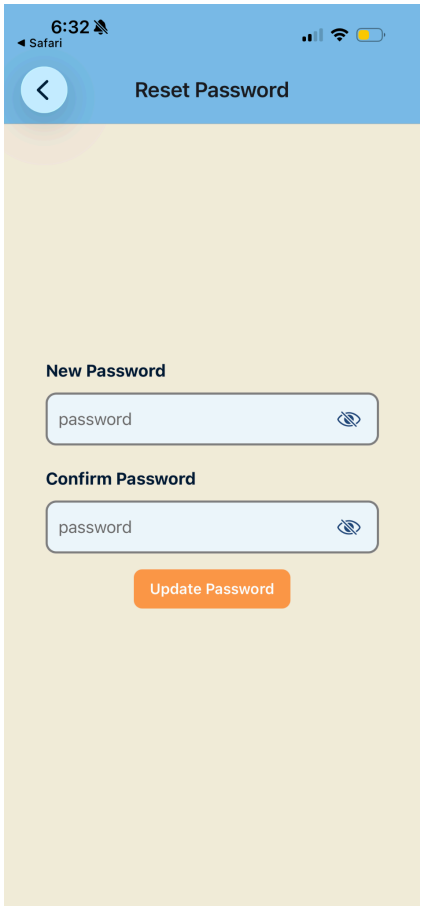

Figure 3.1.3 — Reset Password Screen

Cautions and Warnings

- There are many different pop ups that contain error messages which could occur depending on whether the error is from the user input, database, etc. read the error message carefully and follow the instructions. Potential error messages include:
    - “Error checking registrants list” An error occurred when checking the registrants list please try again.
    - “Email not in registrants list” The email entered is not in the registrants list.
    - “Email and password required” The email and password input fields could be empty.
    - “Incorrect password, or no account found. Please verify password or create an account” An error occurred while logging in please ensure your information is entered correctly and try again. If this error continues to persist please contact the IWAC administrator.
- The reset password screen can only be accessed from a link sent to your email account after completing the “Forgot Password” steps. These links can only be valid once after being sent.

Procedures

Setup and Installation

1. The Login screen is the default screen when you load the application.

Login

1. Enter in your email and password.
2. Click the ‘Login’ button.

Forgot Password

1. Click the ‘Forgot Password’ button.
2. Enter email address.
3. Click the ‘Send Reset Link” link. The email may be sent to your spam folder.
4. Click the one-time-link from the email to be redirected to the ‘Reset Password’ screen.
5. Enter new password and confirmation password.
6. Click the “Update Password” button.

View Privacy Policy

1. Click the “Privacy Policy” button.

Expected Results

The user will be logged into their account and they will be redirected to the ‘Personal Agenda’ screen.

Probable Errors and Possible Causes

Error messages can pop up on the screen should it be necessary. The errors will either be about the user input, then you will just need to follow the instructions that the error message states and you can attempt to login again. Please see the cautions and warnings section of the Login screen to see all potential error messages.

The errors could also be about a problem with the call to the database in which case you should be able to attempt to log in as long as the Supabase services are active.

3.2 Panels Module

This section covers how to use the panel scheduling features of the IWAC application. The user agenda allows authenticated users to view and manage the conference panels they have saved to their personal agenda. The module has four key features. The agenda list view which displays the panels saved by the user, removing a panel from the user’s agenda, browsing to the sessions page to select more panels, and finally viewing panel details. Users are able to view the

full panel details by clicking on any panel they have favorited. No technical knowledge is needed to perform these actions.

3.2.1 Sessions Screen

Functional Description

The Sessions screen is the main page for viewing conference panels. When you open the sessions section of the app, you are presented with a list of panels. Each panel entry may include information such as the panel title, location, speaker, date, session block, topic tag(s), abstract, and materials title and link. The screen supports filtering by topic and by session block, and it also includes a search field for narrowing results. Users can tap a panel to open its detail view.

At the top of the screen, users can interact with filter controls to search through the list of displayed panels. A search bar allows attendees to search sessions by text. Dropdown filters allow users to narrow sessions by topic or by session.

Selecting a panel opens the Panel Detail screen, where more information about that session is displayed. The sessions list is populated from conference panel data stored in the application database.

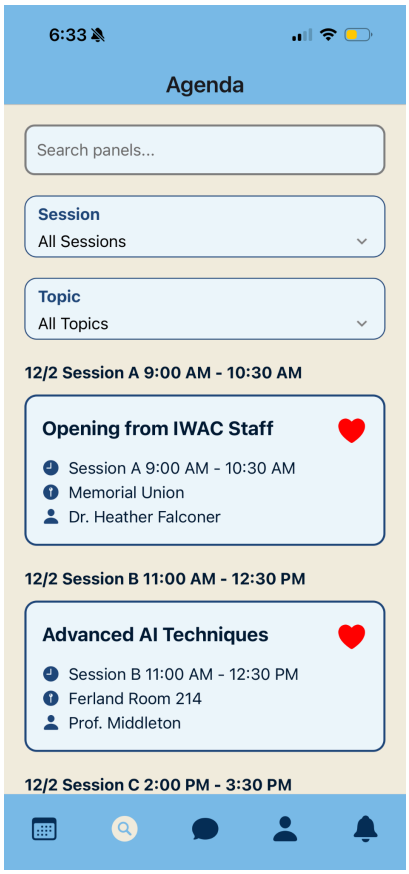

Figure 3.2.1 — Sessions Screen

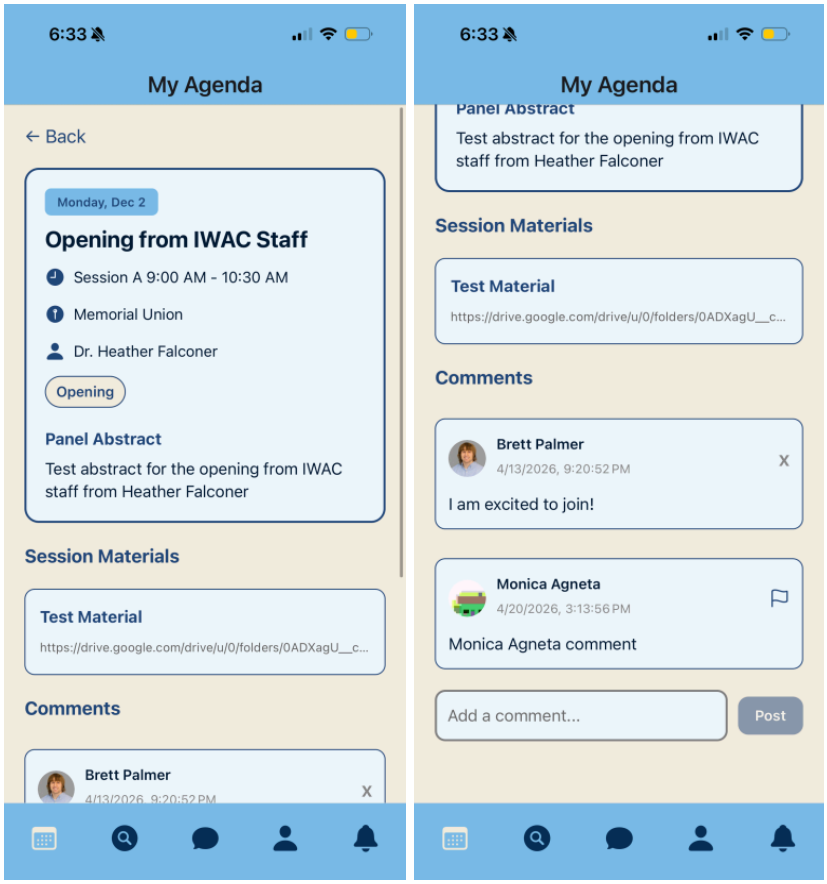

Figure 3.2.2 — Panel Details Screen

Cautions and Warnings

- This screen only displays sessions that have been loaded from the conference database. If panel data fails to load, the list may appear incomplete or empty.
- Filter settings may hide sessions from view. If you cannot find an expected panel, clear the search text and any selected topic or session filters before trying again.
- Session materials, if provided, may link to an external resource such as Google Drive. Opening those resources may require internet access.
- Reporting a comment adds the comment to the administrator's dashboard that is reviewed and acted upon within 24 hours.

Procedures

Setup and Installation

No setup is required to use the Sessions screen besides logging into your IWAC account and opening the app. The screen loads conference panel data automatically when opened.

Viewing Sessions

1) Navigate to the Sessions screen using the bottom navigation bar.
2) Wait a few seconds for the session list to load.
3) Browse the displayed list of conference panels, scrolling as needed.

Viewing Full Panel Details

1) Locate the conference panel on the Sessions screen that you would like to know more about.
2) Click the conference panel.
3) The Panel Details view will open, which displays the previously shown information with an additional abstract, and session materials linked through Google Drive.
4) Click on the back arrow to return to the Sessions page.

Publish a Comment

1) Locate the "Add a comment…" field.
2) Type the text you wish to publish as a comment.
3) Click the "post" button to publish it.

Delete a Comment

1) Locate a comment you published that you wish to delete.
2) Click the "x" icon on your comment to delete it.

Report a Comment

1) Locate a comment that you wish to report to the administrator.
2) Click the flag icon on the comment to report it.

Undo Comment Report

1) Locate a comment that you wish to undo your report of.
2) Click the colored in flag icon on the comment to undo the report of it.

Adding a Panel to Your Agenda

1) Locate the conference panel on the Sessions screen that you would like to add to your agenda.
2) Click the heart on the top right of the panel to save it to your agenda.

Searching Sessions

1) Tap the search field near the top of the Sessions screen.
2) Type a keyword related to the session you want to find.
3) The displayed list will only return the sessions with that keyword.

Filtering by Topic

1) Use the topic filter on the Sessions screen.
2) Select the topic you want to view.
3) The screen will update to show only panels with that topic tag.

Filtering by Session

1) Use the session filter on the Sessions screen.
2) Select the session you want to view.
3) The screen will update to show only panels at that session time.

Expected Results

The session list should load within a few seconds after opening the screen. Users should be able to search and filter available panels by topic and session block. Selecting a panel should open its detail page.

Probable Errors and Possible Causes

Sessions not loading: The application may have lost its internet connection, or the conference database may not be responding.

Expected session not visible: A topic filter, session filter, or search term may be hiding the panel from the list. Clear filters and search text, then try again.

Materials link does not open: The external resource may be unavailable, or your device may not currently have internet access.

3.2.2 User Agenda Screen

Functional Description

The User Agenda is where an authenticated user can view conference panels they have favorited, and manage them all in one place. When you first open the app, you are directed to the agenda page which displays a scrollable list of the panels a user has favorited. Each panel includes information such as the panel title, location, speaker, date, session block, and topic tag(s). Clicking any favorited panel opens the full details of the panel which further includes the panel's abstract and linked materials.

Users can remove a panel from their agenda by clicking on the red "x" button in the top-right corner of the panel. A 'Browse More Panels" button at the top of the page navigates to the sessions page where users can view and favorite additional panels.

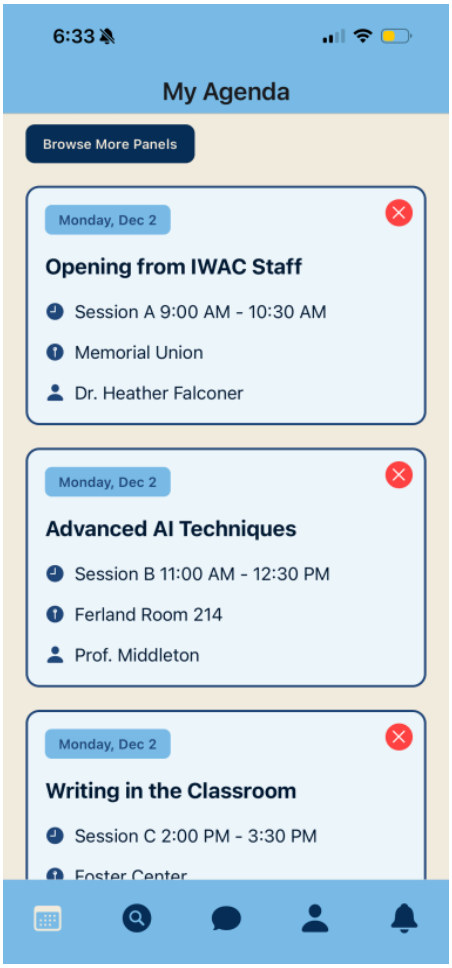

Figure 3.2.3 — User Agenda Screen

Cautions and Warnings

- You must be an authenticated user to view the agenda page and favorite conference panels.
- Removing a conference panel from your agenda cannot be undone, as removal occurs from the user's agenda immediately with a confirmation pop-up. To add a panel back to the user agenda, the user must navigate to the sessions page and re-favorite it.

Procedures

Setup and Installation

1. Log in as an authenticated user.
2. Click on the "Browse More Panels" button to open the sessions page.
3. Favorite a panel by clicking the heart icon on any conference panel.
4. Click the calendar icon in the button navigation bar to return to the agenda page.

5. Your favorited conference panels will load automatically, scroll down the list to review your saved panels.

Viewing Full Panel Details

5) Locate the conference panel on the Sessions screen that you would like to know more about.
6) Click the conference panel.
7) The Panel Details view will open, which displays the previously shown information with an additional abstract, and session materials linked through Google Drive.
8) Click on the back arrow to return to the My Agenda page.

Removing a Panel

1. On the agenda page, choose the panel you wish to remove from your agenda.
2. Tap the red "x" icon in the top-right corner of the panel.
3. The panel will be removed from your agenda immediately. A pop-up message will confirm the removal.

Adding a Panel

1. On the agenda page, click the "Browse More Panels" button in the top left corner of the screen.
2. You will be directed to the Sessions page where you can search and filter through all conference panels.
3. Click the heart icon to save it to your agenda, click the calendar icon on the bottom navigation bar to return to the agenda page and view the panels you have saved.

Expected Results

The user agenda page should load within a few seconds after logging in to the application. Users should be able to save panels to their agenda once they click the "Browse More Panels" button and favorite a panel. Selecting a panel should open its detail page.

Probable Errors and Possible Causes

User Agenda not visible: The user is not authenticated or their session has expired. Return to the login page and sign in again.

Failed to load user agenda: The application may have lost its internet connection. Check your connection and try navigating from and back to the Agenda screen.

Failed to remove panel: The application may have lost its internet connection. Check your connection and try reclicking the remove button.

3.3 Profile Module

This section covers how to use the profile feature of the IWAC application. The profile module allows conference attendees to create a personal profile highlighting any personal details the user wishes to disclose. The profile module has three core components. The edit profile button, which takes you to a page where you can change your profile details, a log out button to log out of the application, and when visiting someone else's profile, the option to message the user appears in place of the edit profile button. No technical knowledge is needed to perform any of these actions.

3.3.1 Profile Screen

Functional Description

The profile screen is where you can view your own profile, or at times, another user's profile. When you open the profile section of the app from the bottom navigation bar, you will see your own profile. Here, you can edit your profile information, or log out. Whenever you click on another user's profile picture, however, you will instead see their profile, and in place of the "edit profile" button, the user will see a "message user" button instead, which will take you to a screen where you can send them a message, which is covered in section 3.5.

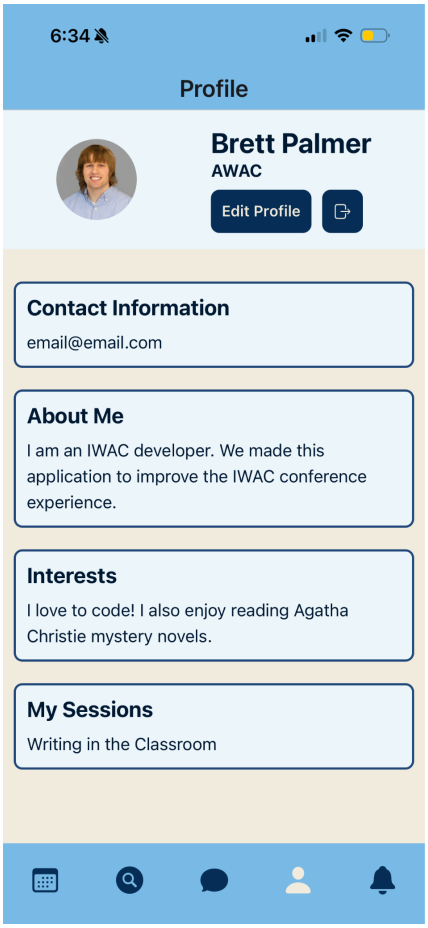

Figure 3.3.1 - User Profile Screen

Cautions and Warnings

- Your profile is not private, and any information on it may be viewed by any other user, with the exception of users that you have blocked, in which case, they can only view your name. .
- Despite there being no content moderation filter, administrators may intervene in cases of excessive explicit content on a user's profile.
- User profiles may be reported for inappropriate content. These reports are uploaded to a dashboard and addressed by an administrator within 24 hours.
- Users may block other users. Blocking another user will prevent them from messaging you, or viewing any information on your profile besides your name.
- The user must be logged in to view anyone's profile, or to create or edit their own.

Procedures

Setup and Installation

Once logged in, the user is free to fill out any information on their profile that they wish to add, or they may choose to leave it blank. Besides this, nothing else needs to be done.

Viewing Your Own Profile

Click on the profile icon on the bottom navigation bar.

Editing Your Profile

Click on the “edit profile” button when viewing your own profile.

Logging Out Your Profile

Click on the button next to the “edit profile” button when viewing your own profile.

Viewing Someone Else’s Profile

Click on their profile picture from anywhere on the app, such as the messages screen or the Search Users screen.

Blocking and Unblocking Other Users

When viewing another user’s profile, you can click the button under their name with a circle with a line through it. Doing so will block the user. To unblock them, you can click the button labeled “Unblock”.

Reporting and Unreporting Other Users

When viewing another user’s profile, you can click the button under their name that has an outline of a flag. Doing so will report the user. To unreport them, you can click the same button, except now the flag will be filled in white.

Expected Results

Your full profile should load within a few seconds, with all of your data included.

Probable Errors and Possible Causes

Profile not loading: The application may have lost its internet connection. Check your connection and try navigating from and back to the Profile screen.

Profile information missing: It is possible that the profile was not properly saved when the profile information was added. Try editing your profile information and try again.

3.3.2 Edit Profile Screen

Functional Description

This screen allows the user to edit any of the information on their profile, including their name, contact information, interests, academic affiliations, and profile picture. Users may also delete their accounts from this screen.

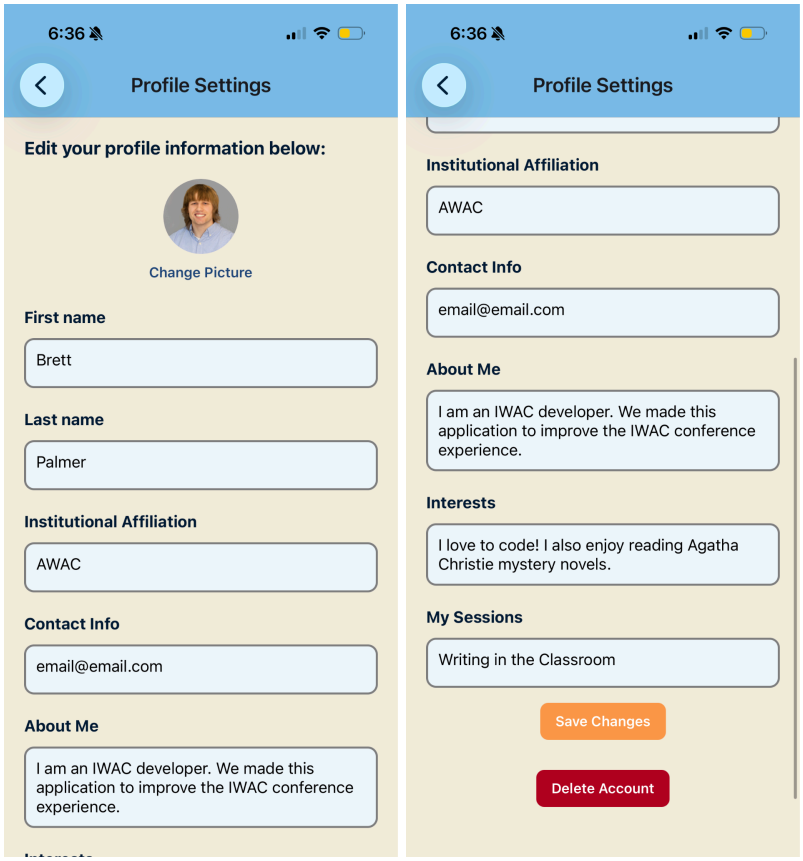

Figure 3.3.2 - Edit Profile Screen

Cautions and Warnings

- There is a “save changes” button at the bottom of this screen, which must be clicked for any of the information put on this screen to be properly saved to your profile. Ensure that the first name and last name fields are filled in, as those are mandatory fields. Otherwise, the changes will not take effect.

Procedures

Setup and Installation

As soon as a profile has been created, and the user has logged in, then the edit profile screen will be available to the user. Simply navigate to your profile using the bottom navigation bar, and click “Edit Profile”.

Saving New Data

Once you have written all the information you wish to update your profile with, simply click the button at the bottom of the screen to save your data. The first and last name fields are mandatory, and profile changes will not be saved without them, but the remaining fields, which are institutional affiliation, contact information, about me, interests, and my sessions, are optional.

Updating Your Profile Picture

Clicking the “Change Picture” button will display your device’s saved photos. After selecting the desired picture, and clicking “save changes”, your profile picture will be updated to the new image.

Deleting Your Account

At the bottom of the screen, there is a red “Delete Account” button. Clicking this will delete your account and all associated data with it.

Expected Results

Your full profile, along with your new profile information, should be visible when you navigate back to your profile.

Probable Errors and Possible Causes

Profile information not updating: The application may have lost its internet connection. Check your connection and try navigating from and back to the edit profile screen.

3.4 Notification Module

This section covers how to use the notification feature of the IWAC application. This module lets users receive notifications regarding the events they’ve added to their agenda. No technical knowledge is needed to perform these actions.

3.4.1 Notifications Screen

Functional Description

The Notifications screen is where you can see all your notifications. Any new notification is marked as “unread” by default, and appears in bold. If you click on any notification, it will be unboldened, and marked as “read”. In addition, only notifications made after creating an account will be visible.

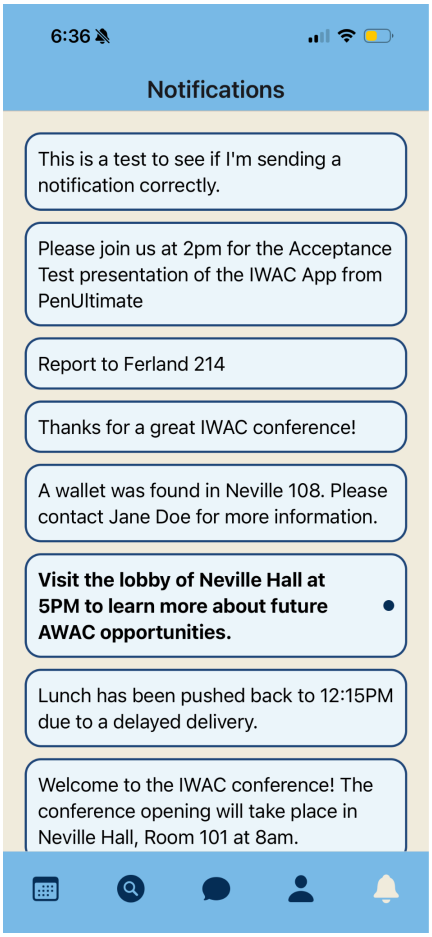

Figure 3.4.1 - Notifications Screen

Cautions and Warnings

- This shows both read and unread notifications. Notification read statuses are private and only used for convenience. However, any notification can be marked as read, but once marked as read, it cannot be marked as unread again.

Procedures

Setup and Installation

No setup is required to use the Notifications screen, besides logging into your IWAC Account. Simply tap the notifications icon at the bottom navigation bar to begin.

Viewing Notifications

Notifications are scrollable, and sorted in order of recency.

Marking a notification as read

Simply tap on a boldened notification to unbolden it, marking it as read in the process.

Expected Results

Your full notifications list should load within a few seconds, ordered by your most recent notification, with “unread” notifications appearing in bold.

Probable Errors and Possible Causes

Notifications not loading: The application may have lost its internet connection. Check your connection and try navigating from and back to the Notifications screen.

3.5 Messaging Module

This section covers how to use the messaging features of the IWAC application. The messaging module lets conference attendees connect and communicate with each other directly through the app. The messaging module has three core components. Visit the Messages screen to see all of your ongoing conversations. Use the Search Users screen to find and message someone new. Finally, visit the Conversation screen to send and receive messages with a particular user. No technical knowledge is needed to perform these actions.

3.5.1 Messages Screen

Functional Description

The Messages screen is the main hub for your conversations. When you open the messaging section of the app from the bottom navigator, this is the first thing you see. It shows a list of everyone you’ve had a conversation with, including each person’s name, profile picture, and the most recent message with them. Conversations with unread messages are highlighted with an orange border and bold preview text. The list updates automatically, so no manual refresh is needed to see incoming messages.

At the top of the screen, an input field allows you to filter your existing conversations by name. This is useful if you have a lot of conversations and want to find one with a specific person. If you want to start a brand new conversation with someone you haven't messaged before, there is a "+" button next to the search bar that takes you to the Search Users screen, which is covered in section 3.5.2.

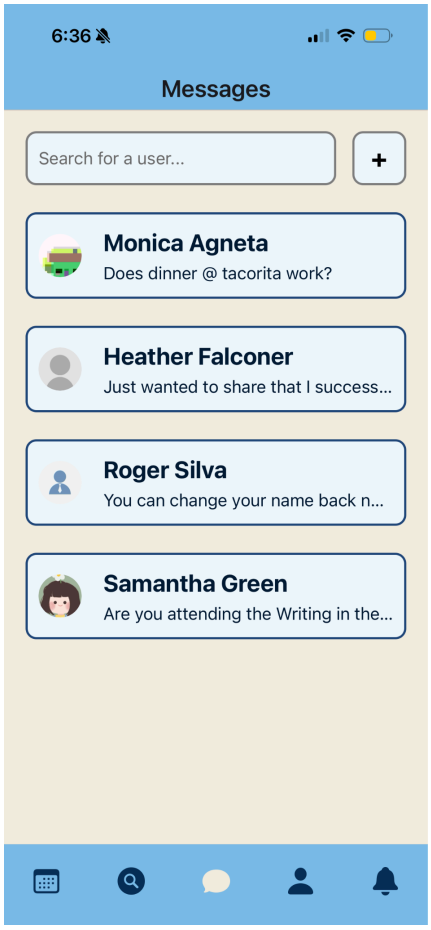

Figure 3.5.1 — Messages Screen

Cautions and Warnings

- This screen only previews conversations that have already been initiated. It does not search for new users. To message someone new, use the "+" button.
- The unread indicator exists to help you quickly identify messages that you have not opened yet. Other users cannot see whether you have read their messages.
- Your list of conversations is private to your account.
- If you have blocked a user or they have blocked you, the conversation will not show here. If you unblock the user from the Search Users screen, then the conversation will reappear.
- If you have not messaged any users yet, the messages portion of this screen will be empty.

Procedures

Setup and Installation

No setup is required to use the Messages screen, besides logging into your IWAC Account. Simply tap the messages icon at the bottom navigation bar to begin.

Viewing Your Conversations

1. Navigate to the Messages screen from the bottom navigation bar.
2. Your conversations will load as a list. Each entry shows the other person's profile picture, name, and a preview of the last message.
3. Scroll down to see older conversations if the list is long.

Searching Your Conversations

1. Tap the search bar at the top of the Messages screen.
2. Begin typing someone's first, last, or full name. The list will filter in real time to show your conversations with any matches to your input.
3. Clear the search bar to return to the full list.

Starting A New Conversation

1. Tap the "+" Button to the right of the search bar to open the Search Users screen. See Section 3.5.2 for information on its usage.

Opening a Conversation

1. Tap on any conversation in the list to visit the Conversation screen. See section 3.5.3 for information on its usage.

Expected Results

Your full conversation list should load within a few seconds, ordered by your most recent messaging activity. If someone messages you while the screen is open, their conversation will instantly move to the top.

Probable Errors and Possible Causes

Conversations not loading: The application may have lost its internet connection. Check your connection and try navigating from and back to the Messages screen.

Conversation is missing: There may not be an existing message between you and the other user, or one of you may have blocked the other. Try accessing the conversation through the Search Users screen to learn more.

Search shows no results: Check the spelling of the name. Both first and last name are accepted.

3.5.2 Search Users Screen

Functional Description

The Search Users screen is a modal that lets you find any other IWAC app user and start a conversation with them. It is accessed by tapping the "+" button on the Messages screen. It displays a scrollable list of all registered app users, excluding yourself, each shown with their profile picture and full name. A search bar at the top lets you filter the list by first or last name in real time. Tapping a user's profile picture takes you to their profile, whereas tapping their name takes you directly to the Conversation screen, covered in section 3.5.3.

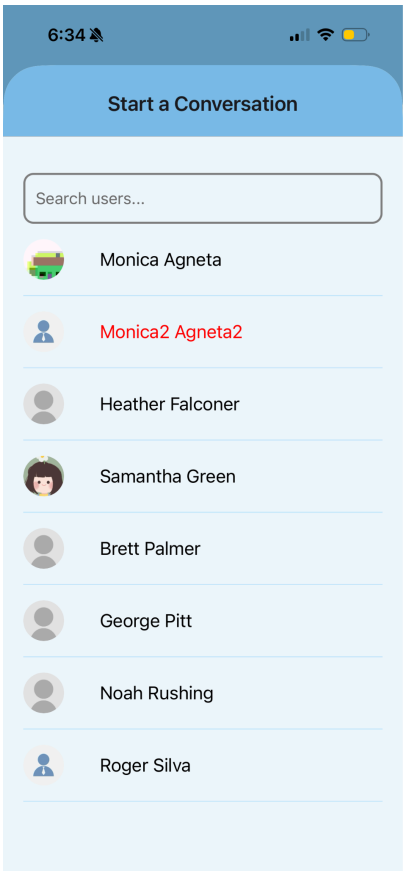

Figure 3.5.2 — Search Users Screen

Cautions and Warnings

- Only users who have created an IWAC app account will appear here. Conference registration and app registration are separate. If you cannot find someone, they likely have not signed up for the app yet.

- If a user has blocked you, then you are unable to use this screen to start a conversation with them or view their profile. Their name will appear in grey.
- This is the only screen in which you can view users that you have blocked. These users' names will appear in red text. You may click their profile icon to load a limited version of their profile, from which you can unblock them.

Procedures

Setup and Installation

No setup is required to use the Search Users screen, besides logging into your IWAC account. It is accessed by tapping the "+" button on the Messages screen.

Searching for a User

1. From the Messages screen, tap the "+" button to the right of the search bar.
2. The Search Users screen will open, displaying a list of all other app users sorted alphabetically by last name.
3. Begin typing someone's first, last, or full name. The list will filter in real time to show any matches.
4. Scroll through the results if needed.

Starting a conversation

1. Tap the name of the person you want to message to be taken directly to the Conversation screen. See section 3.5.3 for information on its usage.

Viewing a profile

1. Tap the profile picture of the person whose profile you want to view to be taken directly to the Profile screen. See section 3.3.1 for information on its usage.

Expected Results

The full user list should load within a few seconds. Typing in the search bar should almost immediately narrow down the list. Tapping a user's profile picture will transition you to their profile. Additionally, tapping their name will transition you to the Conversation screen, where any existing message history with that person will be displayed.

Probable Errors and Possible Causes

List appears empty: The screen may have failed to load due to a lost internet connection. Close and reopen the Search Users screen to try again.

Person not appearing: Either you misspelled their name, or they have not created an IWAC app account yet.

3.5.3 Conversation Screen

Functional Description

The Conversation screen is where you send and receive messages with another user. It displays your full message history as a scrollable chat, with your messages on the right and the other person's on the left. Each message shows a timestamp beneath it. The screen opens scrolled to the most recent message and updates in real time as new messages arrive. At the bottom there is an input field and an orange send button for writing and sending messages.

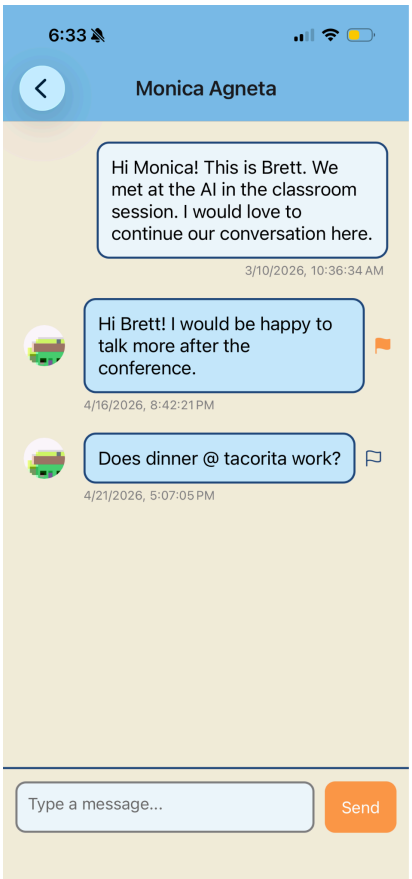

Figure 3.5.3 — Conversation Screen

Cautions and Warnings

- Upon opening a conversation, it is marked as read. The unread status is used to highlight unread conversations on your Messages screen, and is not reported to the other user.

- Messages cannot be edited or deleted after sending. Check your message before sending.
- The app does not show delivery receipts, but messages are saved to the server as soon as they are sent successfully.
- Timestamps reflect each message's time of submission in your device's local timezone, which may differ from the sender's.
- If another user is sending you inappropriate messages, you can report their messages here and block them from their profile to prevent further communication.
- Keep your messages appropriate and respectful to prevent your account from being deleted.

Procedures

Setup and Installation

No setup is required, besides logging into your IWAC account. The Conversation screen can be accessed by tapping a conversation from the Messages screen, selecting a user from the Search Users modal, or tapping "Message User" on someone's profile.

Reading Messages

1. Open a conversation from the Messages screen, Search Users screen, or someone else's Profile screen.
2. Your message history loads, scrolled to the most recent message.
3. Scroll up to read older messages. Your messages appear on the right, and the other person's appear on the left alongside their profile picture.

Sending a Message

1. Tap the input field at the bottom of the screen labeled "Type a message…"
2. Type your message. The field will expand to support multiple lines.
3. Tap the orange send button to the right of the input field. If successful, your message will appear immediately in the conversation and the input field will clear.

Receiving Messages

1. If the other user sends you a message while you have the conversation open, the application will instantly scroll down to the new message at the bottom of the screen.
2. If you are elsewhere in the app, the Messages screen will show an unread indicator for the conversation.

Reporting a Message

1. Select the unfilled flag icon next to the offensive message.
2. When the "Report Message" pop-up appears, confirm the action or select "Cancel" to go back.

3. Once the report is processed, you will see a confirmation message that a system administrator will review the content and take action within 24 hours.
4. When you dismiss the confirmation, the flag icon will now be filled, indicating a submitted report.

Unreporting a Message

1. Select the filled flag icon next to the reported message.
2. When the “Unreport Message” pop-up appears, confirm the action or select “Cancel” to go back.
3. Once the report removal is processed, you will see a confirmation message that the message has been successfully unreported.
4. When you dismiss the confirmation, the flag icon will now be unfilled, indicating the lack of a report.

Expected Results

Your message history should load within a few seconds of opening the screen. After tapping send, your message appears immediately and the input field clears. Incoming messages appear in real time while the screen is open and you have an active internet connection.

Probable Errors and Possible Causes

Messages not loading: The screen may have failed to load due to a list internet connection. Close and reopen the conversation to try again.

Send button does nothing: Ensure that you have an internet connection.

Timestamps look incorrect: Timestamps use your device’s local time zone, which may differ from your conversation partner’s.

4. Error Messages and Recovery Procedures

This section provides an overview of the error messages that users may encounter when using the application, along with guidance on how to resolve them. Errors are organized by screen to make locating the relevant information easier. If a problem persists after attempting the suggested steps to resolve, users are encouraged to contact the IWAC Conference administrator for further assistance.

4.1 Create Account Screen Error Messages

- "**Email and password required**". Email, password, or confirm password input areas could be empty. Ensure that all fields are filled out and try again.
- "**First and last name required**". First name or last name input areas could be empty. Ensure that both fields are filled out and try again.
- "**Password must be at least 6 characters**". Ensure your password is at least 6 characters in length and try again.
- "**Passwords do not match**". Password and confirm passwords do not match. Please ensure that they are entered correctly and try again.
- "**Error creating account, please try again**". Error creating account with database. Ensure information is entered correctly and try again.
- "**An IWAC App account already exists with this email.**". The email entered is already on the registrants list. Please contact the IWAC administrator.
- "**Your email is not allocated within the list of registrants please contact the IWAC administrator.**". Your email is not allocated within the list of registrants. Please contact the IWAC administrator

4.2 Login Screen Error Messages

- "**Error checking registrants list**". An error occurred when checking the registrants list. Please ensure that there is a reliable internet connection and try again.
- "**Email not in registrants list**". The email entered is not in the registrants list. Ensure that the email being used to log in with is the same as the one used to create the account and try again.
- "**Email and password required**". The email and password input fields could be empty. Ensure that both are filled out properly and try again.
- "**Incorrect password, or no account found. Please verify password or create an account**". An error occurred while logging in, please ensure your information is entered correctly and try again. If an account has been created, passwords can be changed by clicking on "forgot password" on the login screen. If this doesn't work, please contact the IWAC administrator. If an account has not yet been created, then please select "create account" to continue.

4.3 User Agenda Screen Error Messages

- "**Please log in to view your agenda**". The user is currently logged out, and must be logged in to view their agenda. Please log in and try again.
- "**Failed to load your agenda**". An error occurred when trying to load the user's agenda. Please ensure that there is a reliable internet connection and try again.

- **“Please log in**”. The user is currently logged out, and needs to log in.
- “**Failed to remove panel**”. An error occurred when trying to remove a panel from the user’s agenda. Please ensure that there is a reliable internet connection and try again.

4.4 Sessions Screen Error Messages

- “**Failed to remove panel**”. An error occurred when trying to remove a panel from the user’s agenda. Please ensure that there is a reliable internet connection and try again.
- “**Failed to save panel**”. An error occurred when trying to add a panel to the user’s agenda. Please ensure that there is a reliable internet connection and try again.

4.5 Profile Settings Error Messages

- “**Failed to save profile changes**”. An error occurred when trying to update profile information. Please ensure that there is a reliable internet connection and try again.
- “**Failed to upload avatar**”. An error occurred when trying to add or change a profile picture. Please ensure that there is a reliable internet connection and try again. If the error persists, it could be due to the selected image being too large. Select a smaller image and try again.
- “**Failed to pick image**”. An error occurred when trying to select an image for the profile picture. This can happen if the user does not give the app permission to view their photo gallery. Please update the app’s permission settings and try again.
- “**Could not load profile data**”. An error occurred when trying to load the user’s profile information. Please ensure that there is a reliable internet connection and try again.

4.6 Notifications Screen Error Messages

- “**Failed to mark notification as read**”. An error occurred when trying to mark a notification as read. Please ensure that there is a reliable internet connection and try again.
- “**Could not fetch notifications**”. An error occurred when trying to load the notifications. Please ensure that there is a reliable internet connection and try again.

5. Glossary

Agenda - A personalized list of conference panels a user has favorited.
Authenticated User - A user who is logged into the application.
Notifications - Messages from conference administrators that inform users about updates related to the conference.
Panel - A scheduled conference event that includes a speaker and related materials.
Panel Materials - Resources associated with a conference panel, accessed through a Google Drive link.
Registrant List - A database list of users who have registered for the IWAC conference and are eligible to create an account.
Session - A time block of the conference in which multiple panels occur.
Sessions Screen - Page of the application where users can browse, search for, and filter conference panels.

Appendix A – Team Review Sign-off

All team members have signed to acknowledge they have reviewed this document and agreed on both its content and format. If team members have minor disagreements, they may state them in the comments area.

Rebecca Sonnemann

Signature: _____ Date: 4/28/2026

Comments: Rebecca Sonnemann (Apr 28, 2026 18:49:18 EDT)

Brett Palmer

Signature: _____ Date: 4/28/2026

Comments: Brett Palmer (Apr 27, 2026 16:09:14 EDT)

Monica Agneta

Signature: _____ Date: 4/28/2026

Comments: Monica Agneta (Apr 27, 2026 18:53:19 EDT)

Ben Caras

Signature: Benjamin Caras Date: 4/28/2026

Comments: Benjamin Caras (Apr 28, 2026 22:19:00 EDT)

George Pitt

Signature: George Pitt Date: 4/28/2026

Comments: George Pitt (Apr 27, 2026 19:00:41 EDT)

Heather Falconer

Signature: _____ Date: 4/28/2026

Comments: Heather Falconer

Appendix B – Document Contributions

Listed below are the contributions from each team member, and which sections of the document they worked on.

Brett

Brett wrote section 3.5. External to this document he wrote the App Store listing, and privacy policy.

Monica

Monica wrote section 1, section 3.2.2, and section 5.

George

George wrote sections 3.3, 3.4, and section 4.

Rebecca

Rebecca wrote section 2 as well as section 3.2.1.

Ben

Ben wrote section 3.1 and helped with section 4.

PenUltimate User Guide

Final Audit Report 2026-04-29

Created:	2026-04-27
By:	Ben Caras (benjamincaras64@gmail.com)
Status:	Signed
Transaction ID:	CBJCHBCAABAAMmZ2lIeoNwVUQ2bLaFXtP65ugGp9s92H

"PenUltimate User Guide" History

Document created by Ben Caras (benjamincaras64@gmail.com)
2026-04-27 - 7:31:11 PM GMT

Document emailed to rebecca.sonnemann@maine.edu for signature
2026-04-27 - 7:31:19 PM GMT

Document emailed to Brett Palmer (brett.palmer@maine.edu) for signature
2026-04-27 - 7:31:20 PM GMT

Document emailed to monica.agneta@maine.edu for signature
2026-04-27 - 7:31:20 PM GMT

Document emailed to benjamin.caras@maine.edu for signature
2026-04-27 - 7:31:21 PM GMT

Document emailed to george.pitt@maine.edu for signature
2026-04-27 - 7:31:21 PM GMT

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2026-04-27 - 7:31:21 PM GMT

Email viewed by Brett Palmer (brett.palmer@maine.edu)
2026-04-27 - 8:08:43 PM GMT

Document e-signed by Brett Palmer (brett.palmer@maine.edu)
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2026-04-27 - 10:58:22 PM GMT

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2026-04-28 - 10:47:35 PM GMT

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